

Urvi Maheshwari
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EDUCATION

University of California San Diego (UCSD)

Ph.D. in Experimental Psychology

San Diego, CA, USA

Expected June 2027

University of California San Diego (UCSD)

M.A. in Experimental Psychology

San Diego, CA, USA

June 2023

University of Western Ontario (UWO)

Huron University College

B.A. (Honours) – *with Distinction*

Honours Specialization in Psychology,

Major in History, Scholar's Electives Program

London, ON, Canada

June 2022

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

*** denotes grants I assisted in writing for new lines of research, including establishing partnerships with research collaborators, building participant pools, designing proposed studies, collecting pilot data, and collaborating with external consultants.*

Duolingo Research Grant

under review

- Title: "Foundations of Early Numeracy and Arithmetic"

Elizabeth Munsterberg Koppitz Child Psychology Graduate Student Fellowship

\$20,800

2026

- Title: "Object Representations in Congenitally Blind Children Following Vision Restoration Surgery"

APA Dissertation Research Award

\$5,000

2025

- Title: "Children's Understanding of the Past and Future"

UC International Institute Social Sciences Graduate Research Grant

\$2,500

2024

- Title: "A cross-linguistic study of children's counting skill and mathematical knowledge"

****UCSD School of Social Sciences Research Grant (PI: David Barner)**

\$19,453

2025

- Title: "Numerical development in blind children following vision restoration surgery"

****UCSD Academic Senate Grant (PI: John Serences)**

\$14,657

2025

- Title: "The role of visual experience in geometric reasoning"

****National Science Foundation #2500305 (PI: David Barner)**

\$750,942

2025-2028

- Title: "Numerical development in children"

****UCSD Academic Senate Grant (PI: David Barner)**

\$13,000

2024

- Title: "Early numeracy in visually impaired children"

Huron Community History Centre Fellowship

\$2,625

2021

- Community collaboration with the Munsee-Delaware First Nation

Huron Centre for Undergraduate Research Learning (CURL) Fellowship

\$1,500

2020

- Title: "The Historical & Philosophical Connection Between Psychical Research and Academic Psychology"

Travel Grants

SPP Travel Award

\$100

2026

Foundry10 Travel Award

\$599

2026

UCSD Norman Anderson Research and Travel Grant x 2

\$715, \$595

2026

UCSD Norman Anderson Research and Travel Grant

\$575

2025

Cognitive Science Society Travel Award

\$1,000

2024

UCSD Norman Anderson Research and Travel Grant x 2

\$900, \$1450

2024

HONOURS AND AWARDS

UCSD Psychology Excellence Award

\$8,000

2022

Moira Samson Award for Excellence in Psychological Research	\$200	2022
David H.M. Stewart Memorial Award “for highest achievement in the graduating class”	\$750	2022
Dean’s Honour List		2019-2022
Professor Fredrick Walter Burd Prize in Psychology	\$500	2021
Fourth Year Seanna and Nicole Strongman Award “for all-round achievement”	\$5,000	2021
Godsoe Family Scholarship of Distinction in Economics and History	\$2,000	2021
Huron College Faculty Association Nelson Heapy Award “for intellectual achievement”	\$500	2020
Douglas Leighton Award in First Nations History	\$200	2020
Jordan Propas Memorial Award “for academic achievement and community involvement”	\$1,500	2020
Huron International Scholarship	\$5000 x 4	2018-2021
Huron Commonwealth Scholarship	\$5000 x 3	2018-2020

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles

1. **Maheshwari, U.**, Sullivan, J., & Barner, D. (2026). Counting without end: A cross-linguistic exploration of infinity beliefs in English and Hindi learners. *Journal of Experimental Child Psychology*, 226, 106473. [[published](#)] [[data](#)]
2. **Maheshwari, U.** & Barner, D. (2026). Back to reality: Children's early temporal reasoning applies to real but not hypothetical events. *Child Development* 97(1), 1-13. [[published](#)] [[psyarxiv](#)] [[data](#)]
3. **Maheshwari, U.** & Barner, D. (2026). Exact numerical reasoning in blind children and adults. *Cognition*, 267, 106351. [[published](#)] [[psyarxiv](#)] [[data](#)]
4. **Maheshwari, U.** & Barner, D. (2025). Twice upon a time: Children use syntax to learn the meanings of yesterday and tomorrow. *Developmental Science*, 28(2), e13600. [[published](#)] [[psyarxiv](#)] [[data](#)]
5. Yu, Y., Boni, I., Cheung, P.,... **Maheshwari, U.**, ... & Barner, D. (Stage 1 registered report: accepted in-principle). ManyNumbers 3: A multi-lab study of demographic correlates of early number knowledge. *Developmental Science*. [[Stage 1 Report](#)]
6. Abreu-Mendoza, R. A., Barner, D., Boni, I.,... **Maheshwari, U.**, ... & Gunderson, E. (Stage 1 registered report: accepted in-principle). ManyNumbers 1: A multi-lab international study of early number knowledge. *Developmental Science*. [[Stage 1 Report](#)].

Book Chapters & Resources

1. **Maheshwari, U.** & Barner, D. (in press). Cross Linguistic Factors in Early Numerical Development. To appear in D. Purpura (ed). *The Intersection of Language and Mathematics: Theories, Empirical Evidence, and Future Directions*. London: Palgrave MacMillan. [[psyarxiv](#)]
2. Van Hedger, S. C. & **Maheshwari, U.** (2025). Language and music in the brain: Balancing domain-specific and domain-general mechanisms. In E. Andrews & S. Kiran. (eds). *The Cambridge Handbook of Language and Brain*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. pp. 459 - 498. [[book](#)] [[chapter](#)]
3. Campbell, N., Barr, L., Bovin, J.,... **Maheshwari, U.** ... & Barrette-Ng, I. (2022). Uncovering the hidden curriculum. *eCampusOntario Special Collections*. [[website](#)] [[DSpace](#)]

Manuscripts Under Review

+ equal contribution

1. **Maheshwari, U.**, Walker C.M., & Barner, D. (under review). Two-year-olds reason about multiple mutually exclusive possibilities. [[psyarxiv](#)]

2. **Maheshwari, U.** & Barner, D. (under revised review). One, two, three, four... what's more? Successor relations, not mappings to approximate magnitudes, support learning the later-greater principle.
3. **Maheshwari, U.**+, Boskovic, K.+, & Barner, D. (under review). The role of analogy in the linguistic encoding of number and space. [[psyarxiv](#)]
4. Yu, Y., **Maheshwari, U.**, & Barner, D. (under review). Cross-modal generalization of numerical calibration.

Manuscripts in Preparation

Below are projects for which data collection is complete, and manuscripts are being prepared for journal submission. Other in-progress projects are not listed.

** undergraduate student*

1. **Maheshwari, U.**, Harris, H.*, Petersen, S.*, & Barner, D. (in prep). A test-retest reliability study of 6-Knowers in the Give-a-Number Framework.
2. **Maheshwari, U.**, Kamble V., & Barner, D. (in prep). Numerical development in congenitally blind children and adults.

INVITED TALKS

1. **Maheshwari, U.** (April, 2025). Language, perception, and procedures in the development of exact number concepts. Presented at the Neuroplasticity and Development Lab, Johns Hopkins University.
2. **Maheshwari, U.** (February, 2024). Words as a window into the world: How young learners build explanations of reality. Presented at the Bjork Learning and Forgetting Lab, University of California Los Angeles (UCLA).
3. **Maheshwari, U.** (August, 2023). Later numbers denote greater magnitudes: The acquisition of a counting principle [Bullet Talk]. Presented at the Workshop on Equality and Exact Number, Online.

CONFERENCE PAPERS AND PRESENTATIONS

Refereed Conference Proceedings (3-6 page papers)

1. Du, H., Sepuri, T., **Maheshwari, U.**, Zhu, R., Arieda, J.O., & Long, B. (in press). Structure and diversity in children's line drawings of object categories across four international contexts. In Proceedings of the Cognitive Computational Neuroscience Conference.
Poster to be presented at the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Computational Neuroscience Society in New York, USA.
2. **Maheshwari, U.** & Barner, D. (2024). Twice Upon a Time: Children Use Syntactic Bootstrapping to Learn the Meanings of Yesterday and Tomorrow. In L. K. Samuelson, S. L. Frank, M. Toneva, A. Mackey, & E. Hazeltine. (eds.). Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society. [[paper](#)]
Talk presented at the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society in Rotterdam, Netherlands.

Symposia and Talks

1. **Maheshwari, U.**, Kamble, V. & Barner, D. (2026, June 23-25). How do blind children learn number words? *Mathematical Cognition and Learning Society Annual Meeting*, Padua, Italy. [declined]
2. **Maheshwari, U.** & Barner, D. (2026, April 10-11). How do children begin to represent the past and future? [Talk]. *Bi-Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society*, Montreal, QC.
Organized & Chaired Symposium: Making a Time Traveler: How Children Reason Over Uncertainty in the Past and Future.
3. **Maheshwari, U.** (2026, February 28). One, Two, Three, Four... and Nothing More. Number Word Learning in Blind Children. [Talk]. *The Southern California Meeting for Investigations in Developmental Science*. San Diego, CA.

4. **Maheshwari, U.**, Sullivan, J. & Barner, D. (2024, June 26-28). The role of language in children’s belief that numbers are Infinite: Insights from Hindi and English learners in India. [Lightning Talk]. *Mathematical Cognition and Learning Society Annual Meeting*, Washington D.C.
5. **Maheshwari, U.** & Peace, T. (2019, November 25). Exercising power through penmanship: the literary contributions of female Indigenous writers in the nineteenth century. [Lightning Talk]. *Annual Conference of the Huron Centre for Undergraduate Research*, London, ON.

Posters

1. **Maheshwari, U.**, Kamble, V. & Barner, D. (2026, June 18-20). The Role of Perception in Number Word Learning: Insights from Blind Children and Adults. *Society for Philosophy and Psychology Annual Meeting*. Baltimore, MD.
2. Yu, Y., **Maheshwari, U.** & Barner, D. (2026, May 16). The cross-modality transfer of calibration effect. [Poster]. *Annual Meeting of the Vision Sciences Society*, St. Pete’s Beach, FL.
3. Harris, H.*, Petersen, S.*, **Maheshwari, U.**, & Barner, D. (2026, February 28). Children Need to Count to Reliably Generate Large Sets. [Poster]. *The Southern California Meeting for Investigations in Developmental Science*. San Diego, CA
4. **Maheshwari, U.** & Barner, D. (2025, November 6-9). Keeping it real: Children’s comprehension of yesterday and tomorrow for autobiographical and hypothetical events [Poster]. *Boston University Conference on Language Development*, Boston, MA.
5. **Maheshwari, U.** & Barner, D. (2024, March 21-23). It’s about time! Acquisition of deictic time words in English and Hindi. [Poster]. *Bi-Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Development Society*, Pasadena, CA.
6. **Maheshwari, U.** & Tsang, C.D. (2022, July 18-20). A bi-directional training paradigm examining the cross-modal relationship between cognitive representations of language and mathematics. [Poster]. *Annual Meeting of the Canadian Society for Brain, Behaviour, and Cognitive Science*, Halifax, NS.
7. **Maheshwari, U.**, Bell, A.H., & Bland, S. (2021, April 30). William James and the nature of scientific inquiry in twentieth-century academic psychology. [Poster]. *Annual Conference of the Huron Centre for Undergraduate Research*, London, ON.

TEACHING

Instructor of Record

Controversies in Cognitive Science	Summer 2026
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Teaching Assistance

<i>UCSD</i>	
Psychology of Human Sexuality	Winter 2026
Cognitive Psychology	Spring 2025
Psychology of Language	Fall 2024
Psychology and the Law (Forensic Psychology)	Summer 2024
Laboratory in Psychophysiological Perception (Social Neuroscience)	Summer 2024
General Psychology: Developmental Foundations	Spring 2024
Developmental Psychology	Fall 2023
The Science of Parenting	Spring 2026, Summer 2023
Laboratory in Social Cognition	Summer 2023
General Psychology: Cognitive Foundations	Winter 2023
<i>UWO</i>	
Method and Theory in General Psychology (2 lab sections)	Winter 2022

Guest Lectures & Workshops

<i>Invited</i>	
Basic Principles in Development (UWO)	February 2026

- Title: “Language Structures as Explanations of Thought”
History of Psychology (UWO) January 2024
- Title: “Statistics, science, and society: What’s the use of history in psychology anyway?”
Psychology: Method and Theory in General Psychology (UWO) September 2021
- Title: “Decolonizing Psychology” +

As Teaching Assistant

- Science of Parenting May 2026
 - Title: “Can I measure my life in marshmallows?”
- Psychology of Human Sexuality February 2026
 - Title: “Safer Sex”
- Cognitive Psychology May 2025
 - Title: “Where do concepts come from?”
- Psychology of Language October 2024
 - Title: “The critical period hypothesis”
- General Psychology: Developmental Foundations May 2024
 - Title: “Theory change and deeper thinking”
- Developmental Psychology November 2023
 - Title: “One, two, three... infinity! The development of early number concepts”
- General Psychology: Cognitive Foundations February 2023
 - Title: “Language acquisition: From sounds to words to meaning”

As Writing Instructor

- Global Studies: Community and Participatory Methodologies (UWO) March 2022
 - Title: “Writing Manifestos” +
- Global Studies: Community and Participatory Methodologies (UWO) February 2022
 - Title: “Document Analysis” +
- History: Women Making Waves (UWO) October 2021
 - Title: “Writing for the General Public”
- Global Studies: Indigenous Peoples and Global Disposessions (UWO) January 2021
 - Title: “Writing Positionality Statements” +
- Interdisciplinary Studies: Developing Research Questions (UWO) September 2021
 - Title: “Reflective Writing”
- Interdisciplinary Studies: Building a Research Project (UWO) January 2021
 - Title: “Critical Reading and Writing for Literature Reviews” +
- Global Studies: Problems of Global Development (UWO) October 2021
 - Title: “Writing Effective Critiques”

Mentorship

Research Assistants

* co-author on in-progress project | †based internationally

- †*Shambhavi Rai 2026-
- †*Saarthak Dahiya 2026-
- †*Siya Kaushik 2026-
- *Sabina Petersen 2025-
- Nancy DeLeon 2025-
- *Ben Solomon 2025-
- *Esha Patel 2025-
- *Jiya Shah 2025-
- *Shrishti Banga 2025-
- *Aathiya Bhardwaj 2025-
- Marianna Thorne 2025
- Hannah Beenan 2025

• *Hannah Harris	2023-2025
• Hongmin (Debbie) Dai	2024-2025
• Sandra Wong	2024-2025
• Jordan Caronne	Summer 2024
• Anna Wohlhieter	2023-2024
• Hannah Bryer	2023-2024
• Violet Scholar	2023-2024
• Haley Lester	2023
• Maansi Narain	Summer 2023

SERVICE & OUTREACH

Outreach	
Co-Founder & Advisory Board Member, Safe Campus Coalition, Canada	2021-2025
Organizer, High School Psychology Visits, <i>UCSD</i> .	2026
Presenter, “Graduate Research Flash Talk”, Diversifying Psychology, <i>UCSD</i> .	2024
Panelist, “Pathways to PhDs”, <i>UCSD</i> .	2024
Panelist, “How to Choose a Graduate Program: Diversifying Psychology”, <i>UCSD</i> .	2023
Panelist, “Global Inclusion Summit”, <i>NASSCOM Foundation</i> , Online.	2022
Panelist, “Pathways to Graduate School”, <i>Huron University College</i> , London, ON.	2022
Panelist, “Advocates: Women of Colour in Student Leadership”, <i>University of Western Ontario</i> , London, ON.	2022
Moderator, “Community History and Collaborative Research: A Conversation with the Wendat/Wandat Women’s Advisory Council”, <i>Huron University College</i> , London, ON.	2022
Host & Moderator, “In Between Truth and Reconciliation with Dr Joyce Green”, <i>Huron University College</i> , London, ON.	2022
Moderator, “Access to Reading and Book Recommendations in Writing Centres.” <i>Canadian Writing Centres Association (CWCA) Annual Conference</i> , Online.	2021
Moderator, “Forming Writing Communities Through A Writing Commons.” <i>Canadian Writing Centres Association (CWCA) Annual Conference</i> , Online.	2021

Institutional Service

<i>UCSD</i>	
Psychology Graduate Program, Peer Mentor	2023-2026
<i>UWO / Huron</i>	
Huron University College Students’ Council, Vice President of Student Affairs	2021-2022
• Ex-officio Vice-Present, Huron Students Events and Affairs Corporation	
Research Ethics Board	2020-2022
Faculty of Arts and Social Science Committee	2020-2022
Academic Senate	2020-2022
Experiential Learning Committee	2020-2022
<i>Ad Hoc</i> Covid-19 Contingency Planning Committee	2021-2022
Indigenous Initiatives Committee	2021-2022

1Read Program Committee	2020-2022
President’s Advisory Committee on Equity and Diversity	2021-2022
Teaching and Research Staff Hiring Committees x 2	2021, 2022
UWO Mental Health Roundtable	2021-2022
UWO University Affairs Roundtable	2021-2022

Professional Affiliations: Cognitive Development Society (CDS); Cognitive Science Society; Mathematical Cognition & Learning Society (MCLS); American Psychological Association (APA)

Ad Hoc Reviews: Developmental Psychology; Open Mind; Cognitive Science Society Proceedings

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Writing & Communications Tutor, Huron Writing Centre	August 2020 – April 2022
Research Assistant, Infant and Child Lab at Huron University College (PI: Dr Christine Tsang)	May 2021 – April 2022
Research Assistant, Huron Department of Psychology (course development)	September 2021 – April 2022
Research Assistant, Huron Department of History (PI: Dr Deanne Van Tol)	May 2021 – August 2021